

DATASET: LOANS

Data Owner: Becky Sgrignuoli

Data Product Manager: Becky Sgrignuoli

Data Department Manager: Linn O'Connor

Engineering Owner: Robert Hwang

Product Owner: Tejash V. Shah

Dataset Description: The Loans Market consists of \$2.6T outstanding across broadly syndicated & institutional segment with a further \$13T multi lender syndicated loans & about \$4T club and bilaterals. We have **6,000 loans users globally** Back-office clients (Loan Operations), Institutional Investors/CLOs, Sell-side banks (league tables).

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Outlines the main initiatives of the dataset, with quarterly updates on progress towards those goals
- **Report release notes**
Highlights notable changes from the previous quarterly report along with click through access to the previous quarter's report
- **Customer use cases**
Consolidates the main customer use cases for the dataset, provides a quick view of where the data is 'fit for purpose' and expected business outcomes if all quality expectations are met
- **State of Quality**
Overview of the current state of the dataset and its target state across the quality dimensions of Accuracy, Coverage and Timeliness.
- **State of Automation**
Provides insight into the automation level of the dataset across the Acquisition, Extraction and Transformation steps of data processing. Opportunities for automation are outlined and show what quality dimensions would be impacted by the automation initiative, and if resource efficiencies could be realized.

Initiative Background

In 2023, we launched a new data quality framework which defines whether a dataset is fit-for-purpose, by considering its accuracy, timeliness, depth and breadth of coverage, and history. This allows us to understand the state of the data, identify gaps, prioritize investments, and provide transparency around our operations. In collaboration with our stakeholders, we are conducting annual meetings to ensure we are tracking the right metrics, have identified priority focus areas and demonstrate progress against those priorities. In addition, we have expanded our State of Data framework beyond Data Quality to include the State of Automation in Q3 '24, and are developing a framework for the State of Alignment. State of Data Reporting brings together key components of our datasets providing a holistic and consistent view.

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2024 Focus Area(s) & Quarterly Updates

Improvement of Data Quality through the development of a Random Sampling workflow which we will roll out in phases to ultimately align with our ideal state once the migration is complete
Infrastructure and Workflow Migration which will result in opportunities for automation and improved data quality (new workflow, screens, etc. deriving data and BRE)
Depth of Coverage expansion deploying fields for preliminary and pricing status based on client/sector demand
Focusing on Breadth and opportunities to establish relationships with banks and other data providers for increased contributions (Specifically in Japan ~30 terminals for sell-side banks)

Q1 2024 Update:

Core Schema Design complete
UI Design complete
BRE pre-work complete

Q2 2024 Update:

30% of fields migrated to BBDS
JIRA workflow design and refinement complete
Quality Random Sampling Workflow Phase 1 Rolled out

Q3 2024 Update:

Phase 1 Quality Random Sampling in progress with automated Monthly Summary sent to stakeholders
LNWF (replacement for FLNS BDAP tool) rolled out in PROD, testing by FTEs commenced
Launch of a New Leveraged Loan Index Based on New Syndicated US Loans Data and Pricing Solution
Started acquiring data from SMBC ahead of YE target in Japan market(we now have 2 of the 3 megabanks submitting)

Q4 2024 Update:

Japan: Achieved tier 1 bank coverage target mentioned in Q3
Loans ingestion schema rolled out and in production -> successful STP of BDC loans
Defined critical fields for completeness and quality reporting for Phase 2

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Report Release Notes:

- **December 31, 2024:**
 - **Correctness:** Reassessed and upgraded quality review/reporting process to align with elevated loans index support standards.(critical EFR)
Current numbers are more representative of data correctness.
Introduced targeted random sampling for data point level accuracy.
 - **Completeness:** Defined critical fields for completion reporting. New reporting established to monitor and baseline completion percentages across critical fields.
 - **Coverage Breadth:** Japan: Achieved tier 1 bank coverage target. Enhanced ultimate target to 600/730B + new Japan LEAG table.
Expanded scope to include 5 tier 2 banks.
EM coverage targets scoped (target subject to TAM approval)
 - **Timeliness:** Transitioned reporting to based on FFP targets but FFP timeliness measurement and progress towards target state is still blocked & dependent on migration.

The previous version of the report can be found [here](#).

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Data Dimension	Current State*		Key Outcomes & Metrics			Comment
			Current	Target	Timing	
Accuracy	Correctness	Investing	EFR: Critical -82% EFR Non Critical -89.44% Non FFP Accuracy -99.4%	EFR: Critical -95% EFR Non Critical -95% FFP Accuracy -99% for Critical fields*	Q3 2025	- Comprehensive reassessment of our accuracy review and reporting of the Critical process to align with the heightened quality demands following the US Loans Index release. - Initiated a performance improvement plan with our outsourced vendors operations to achieve significant improvements needed in the critical EFR, also evaluating new alternate vendor resources with promising initial outcomes. (92% EFR,94% accuracy) - DT resource reallocation toward private credit & BDC has delayed some migration deliveries that are critical for broader quality improvements. (automation and BRE) - A FFP targeted random sampling process has been implemented to measure accuracy at the data point level. Current accuracy levels are being baselined.
	Completeness	Under Review	Critical Fields* (BSL)- 91.4%	TBD	Establish Target by Q2'25	- Established a critical field universe comprising 18 key fields essential for cash flow and analytics - A new measurement/reporting process has been established to monitor and baseline completion percentages - Targeting QoQ improvements-- focus on core data points (margin/price/cov lte)
Coverage	Breadth	Investing	Japan coverage: 420B ~58% (% major banks)	Japan: 500B Identify +5 of tier 2, regional banks	Q2 2025	- No formal transparency into market size to compare coverage 2 of 3 Mega Banks in Japan submitting (MUFG, SMBC, Mizuho expected Q1 '25) -> 80% of the total active market by end of Q2 2025. +30 opportunity terminals in Japan (In pursuit with Sales and App Specs). Release Japan LEAG table Q2 2025 (would be Q1 2025 for Japan fiscal calendar) - Establish relationships with banks in key markets where we have insufficient coverage (Japan and EM) and receiving loan data directly. Ultimate target for Japan Depth is 730B depending on client submission
			EM: +15 top banks identified for contribution	Establish a contribution relationship with 15 EM banks.	Q3 2025	
	Depth	Investing	~350 data points	Complete Loans Index analytics fields +10 preliminary security fields & BSL amortisation +25 enumerations on existing fields	Q2 2025 In stages though Q2 2026	- Prioritising supporting fields for index analytics - Client demand for more transparency into preliminary and pricing data - Pre migration infrastructure does not allow for agile data entry, data capture or field expansion - Assess client demand and market needs for ongoing investment in field creation
	History	Investing	~15 years limited point in time (<5%)	Expanding Fixed coupon PIT Expanded support on go fwd for PIT history for data points (-50%)	Q4 2024 -33% Q4 2025- 75% Q2 2026- 100% of the target	- PIT data within our BBDS migrated datasets (CPNP, CALN, FLBK - which have ~2 years history). - Point in Time coverage support as part of tri temporal BBDS migration
Timeliness		Investing	**Critical: (BSL & Inst) @ 45 mins 64% **Non Critical 81% @5 days	Critical: (BSL & inst) <45mins Non Critical <5 days	FFP Timeliness blocked until Loans Migration	- Current TTM is based on ticket resolution and thus isn't FFP. - Future state to measure time from data availability to loan creation with provenance info per stage. - Furthermore, Streamlining Data acquisition and publication through a combination of infrastructure enhancements, ML extraction and improved acquisition from third party sources is needed - Lack of automation continues to block significant progress towards target.

Use-Case	Brief Description	Accuracy		Coverage			Timeliness	Business outcome
		Correctness	Completeness	Breadth	Depth	History		
Buy Side Trader/Portfolio Manager	Trader: "The trader evaluates loan terms and conditions in real time to execute the portfolio manager's trade strategy. Key pricing and compliance data points are analyzed to select and execute trades across the U.S. and EU BSL (Broadly Syndicated Loan) markets." Portfolio Manager (PM): "The portfolio manager sets asset allocation and defines strategic directives for traders, aiming to optimize portfolio performance. They conduct in-depth research and data analysis to develop strategies that align with and achieve the fund's investment goals and objectives."	Datapoint Accuracy*: 99%	US lev:TBD EMEA Lev:TBD APAC Lev:TBD	US and EMEA BSL  Japan and EM (Investing) Target JAPAN:: 75% Market coverage (500B) EM:Top 15 identified Banks	10 preliminary security fields +25 enumerations on existing field		With partial Automation (BSL & inst new issues) <15mins with Full automation (BSL & Inst) <5mins	Grow loans data customers by delivering Loans reference data, complete with identifiers on the PREL monitor in less than 15 mins, setting a best in class standard. Migration dependent roll out Q4 '24
Sell side Syndication	A comprehensive view of aggregate loan data designed for in-depth analysis, pitch book preparation, and rankings based on credit performance and arranger/bookrunner contributions. These rankings will serve as a key tool for marketing and securing future business opportunities.		US lev:TBD EMEA Lev:TBD APAC Lev:TBD Investment Grade:TBD Asset Financing:TBD Emerging markets: TBD	+a statistical measure of coverage -- CLO coverage/holdings coverage			With partial Automation Deal contributions for LEAG <2.5 days with Full automation Non Critical Deal contributions for LEAG <1 day	Improve LEAG data for Japan (Q2 2025) and EM +30 terminals (Japan) as a result of established strategic relationships


 Current state of data meets the defined use-case and is fit for purpose

Use-Case	Brief Description	Accuracy		Coverage			Timeliness	Business outcome
		Correctness	Completeness	Breadth	Depth	History		
Enterprise data & Data License	A diverse range of client types, including middle and back office trading, syndicate operations, compliance, portfolio management, and market research, utilize loans reference data. Clients can alternatively access the loans dataset via downloadable files. Available both as BULK files and per security files. The data offered in this format represents a subset of the broader loans database, providing essential data points for operational and analytical needs.	Data point accuracy*: 99%	US lev:TBD EMEA Lev:TBD APAC Lev:TBD Investment Grade:TBD Asset Financing:TBD Emerging markets: TBD	US and EMEA BSL Japan and EM (Investing) Target JAPAN:: 75% Market coverage (600B) EM:Top 15 identified Banks +a statistical measure of coverage -- CLO coverage/holdings coverage		Fifteen Year data history True Time -series PIT dataset going forward	With partial Automation Critical: (BSL & inst new issues) <15mins Contributed deals for LEAG <2.5 days with Full automation Critical: (BSL & Inst) <5mins Non Critical <1 day	Boost enterprise revenue growth. Currently \$2 million bulk projected growth @ +8% -\$10.2 million PS projected growth @ +11%
Bloomberg Indices	High client demand for institutional leveraged loan indices for benchmarking (US 1500 loans; EUR 600 loans). Opportunity for Data to leverage index participation as an incentive to enhance completeness via active contributions.	PREL and New issue: EFR 95% Amendments (ex-ca) EFR 95% Datapoint Accuracy*: 99%					With partial Automation Critical: (BSL & inst new issues) <15mins with Full automation Critical: (BSL & Inst) <5mins	Released US Leveraged Loans Index Q4 '24. ~70 firms interested in a loans Index Product (combined \$100bn+ assets) -Improve on BVAL revenue (\$3million) -Release of EUR Leveraged Loan Index expected April 2025

Current state of data meets the defined use-case and is fit for purpose

Use-Case	Brief Description	Accuracy		Coverage			Timeliness	Business outcome
		Correctness	Completeness	Breadth	Depth	History		
BQL	Allowing customers to run queries on fixed income data using BQL syntax, including through natural language queries.	Data point accuracy*: 99%	✓	US and EMEA BSL ✓ Japan and EM (Investing) Target JAPAN:: 75% Market coverage (600B) EM:Top 15 identified Banks +a statistical measure of coverage -- CLO coverage/holdings coverage	Increase BQL supported field count + NLP expression generation via annotation	Fifteen Year Data history ✓ True Time -series PIT dataset going forward	✓	Support BQL business in achieving an increase in usage of BQL by 20% by EOY. Current BQL usage (Apr24) across all asset classes was 74.7k users
BI	Bloomberg Intelligence uses aggregated loan data on a monthly basis to support their leverage loan data dashboard and produce monthly and quarterly insight reports for clients.	PREL and New issue: EFR 95% Amendments (ex-ca) EFR 95%	Distressed (defaults, recovery) Fundamentals (leverage ratios)		Covenants (headrooms)	✓	✓	The outcome is to produce a comprehensive leveraged loans report that provides valuable insights into the market. This report will enable market participants to understand trends, make comparisons, benchmark performance, and gain a complete understanding of the current market landscape "Each loan deck is at least 3000 reads. Even 5000/6000 sometimes. Highest read of all our decks!!"

State of Automation: Loans

Acquisition				Extraction				Transformation			
Obtaining the universe of relevant documents				Extraction fields/data points & normalizing to internal concepts				Advanced additional processing			
# Documents/Yr		264,960.0	Actual	Total Data Points/Yr		2,607,263	Actual	Total Data Points/Yr		0.0	Thousand
Document Acquisition Processing				Extraction & Normalization Processing				Advanced Processing			
Automated	65%	171,101.0	Actual	Automated	1%	13,644.0	Actual	Automated	0%	0.0	Thousand
Semi-Automated	34%	89,955.0	Actual	Semi-Automated	2%	45,480.0	Actual	Semi-Automated	0%	0.0	Thousand
Manual	1%	3,904.0	Actual	Manual	97%	2,548,139.0	Actual	Manual	0%	0.0	Thousand
Rejections	85%	225,896.0	Actual	Resources Focused on this Activity				Resources Focused on this Activity			
Resources Focused on this Activity				Employee		4.75		Employee		0	
Employee		1		Vendor		13.9		Vendor		0	
Vendor		3.25		Contingent Worker		1.16		Contingent Worker		0	
Contingent Worker		0.05									
Data for 2023/2024 on a rolling 12 month basis as of 9-15-2024. Existing Loans acquisition casts a very wide net in creating workunits from documents in legacy FLNS BDAP tool. Config based acquisition rules in FLNS sets much of the processing metadata, proper WI routing and supplemental auto-rejections not needing human intervention				Data for 2023/2024 on a rolling 12 month basis as of 9-15-2024. Nearly all extraction work is done manually by vendor, FTE and CW analysts, with a single automated & semiautomated extraction process targeted as a small % of client bank submissions				There is currently no data transformation taking place.			

Opportunities

Title	Impact Area	Outcome (SoD Measures / Efficiency)	Status	Exp Complete
AI driven Keep/Reject model	Acquisition	SOD Customer Outcome: Decreased volumes of incoming document acquisition for more timely and accurate processing of loan new issue and maintainece events. Existing legacy acquisition methods result in larger volumes of non-actionable and duplicate items requiring manual review, leading to increased time to market for updates reflecting to the terminal. Initial scope targeting Newswire sources should also have downstream internal client impact such as BVAL, News, Index, and PORT. Efficiency Outcome: Reducing non actionable and duplicate items freeing up analyst capacity and actionable items quicker. SOD Dimension Enhanced: Timeliness Expected Results: Intending to expand scope beyond the 3 newswire codes tested over Q32024 for a wider footprint of APAC/EMEA Newswire sources. Aiming to move closer to the SOD target for Non Critical WI types of <5 days from the current 10 day average TAT. Project Overview: Over the course of 2025 due to Loans Workflow migration, the legacy FLNS acquisition methods will need to be deprecated. As such, a well trained classifier logic should not only replace the existing 3 bespoke document acquisition methodologies, but also drastically improve effecticeny of the current keep/reject logic. Initial scope will be to target the Newswire related acquisition services and Non Critical document types, which account for approx 52% of existing document inflows. Leveraging ACN, intending to scale said model both to other regional news sources as well as SMSG and Company Filings.	Researching	Q4 2025
AI research for Client submission extraction/automation	Extraction	SOD Customer Outcome: Streamlined client submission process for sellside contributors by delivering a more timly, robust and comprehensive Loans LEAG product. By fully/partially automating parts of the submission process will aide in more realtime actioning of a wider scope of term sheet and accompanying less templated documents. Efficiency Outcome: Reduce the amout of manual effort by vendor and FTE analysts SOD Dimension Enhanced: Timeliness, Accuracy Expected Results: Acquisition of client bank submissions accounts for approx 28% of the inflow into the Loans workflow. AI play here is intended to target the less structured excerpts from full loan documentation provided as supplemental information to our deal term sheet submission platform for LEAG support, where we receive the majority of our private loan data. These less structured documents provide more comprehensive and accurate data than the free-text templated term sheets otherwise provided. Project Overview: Loans currently uses for a small subset of recurring bank submission templates, a legacy ingestion BBDS dataset and DFR & BAIT, which currently accounts for the 3% extraction and automation of existing workflows. AI and/or advanced regx will be needed for extraction and normaization of less templated documentation (such as excerpts from full, finalization loan documents)	Not Started	TBD

BAIT/DFR for Client submission extraction/automation	Extraction	SOD Customer Outcome: Streamlined client submission process for sellside contributors by delivering a more timely, robust and comprehensive Loans LEAG product. Fully/partially automating parts of the submission process will aide in more realtime actioning of a wider scope of term sheet documents also allowing for increased coverage in historically low engagement banks/regions such as Japan and EM. +30 terminals (Japan) as a result of established strategic relationships Efficiency Outcome: Reduce the amout of manual effort by vendor and FTE analysts SOD Dimension Enhanced: Timeliness, Coverage Expected Results: Acquisition of client bank submissions accounts for approx 28% of the inflow into the Loans workflow. In addition to freeing up analyst time, increased timeliness in addressing the more templated submission documents allows for opportunities to expand coverage in regions such as Japan and EM. Project Overview: Noted above, while porting over the legacy automation processes still in use to new loans bbds ingestion and bbds datastore, explore DFR/BAIT template based extraction for simpler submission types where AI normization might not be needed and could leverage more straight forward normalization	Researching	Q1 2025
AI Finalization Extraction	Extraction	SOD Customer Outcome: Provide comprehensive loans data by efficient extraction from dense credit agreements, enabling faster analysis, more precise comparisons,improved benchmarking & decision making for clients. Boost enterprise revenue growth: Currently \$2 million bulk projected growth @ +8% -> \$10.2 million PS projected growth @ +11% Efficiency Outcome: Currently full agreement extraction and updating is the most manual and resource intensive part of the loans workflow; with highest average KPI of 2+ hours per document and TAT ranging 1 to 10 business days. Even partial STP should both decrease time to market, data integrity and free up capacity of existing headcount. SOD Dimension Enhanced: Coverage, Timeliness Expected Results: Existing process requires 6,00+ manual hours per year, so even incremental process targeting the simpler more structured parts of these documents should decrease time to market and imporve data integrity while freeing up capaity of existing headcount for more complex tasks Project Overview: Loans receives a number of full legal documents (credit agreements, amendments, etc) which represent non templated terms and conditions of instrumrnts we maintain. Similar to Corps Finalization extraction, we need to build out similar models for Covenants, Pricing, Use of Proceeds, etc. Research needed on client impact and which subdatasets to target in 2025	Researching	TBD

Total Dataset Resources

Employee	26
Vendor	24
Contingent Worker	3

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AS OF: Dec 31, 2024